



WHITE PAPER

THE MARKET FOR THE NEXT 15 MINUTES OF ATTENTION

AttentionBid transforms a continuously renewing unit of digital attention into an open, observable market - where price is discovered through competition, the winner controls the next block, and the auction itself can become part of the content.

SCARCE TIME • VISIBLE PRICE DISCOVERY • PERPETUAL AUCTIONS • TOKEN-ALIGNED COMMUNITY

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Discussion Draft - Not an offer to sell securities

ABSTRACT

A New Market Primitive for Digital Attention

AttentionBid proposes a perpetual auction for a scarce, time-bounded digital resource: control of the platform's primary attention surface. Each 15-minute block is allocated through competitive bidding, producing a visible winning price and a new content owner. When one block ends, the next market begins.

The project combines three ideas that already exist independently at scale - digital advertising, auction-based allocation, and crypto-native settlement - into a single consumer-facing market. The central innovation is not simply that advertising is auctioned. It is that the auction, price discovery, winner, and transition of control are intended to be visible parts of the experience.

AttentionBid is operated by a privately held firm. Development began in January 2026, the first public code commits occurred in June 2026, public release is planned for 2026, and a token release is targeted for late 2026, subject to technical and regulatory readiness.

\$294.6B	15 MIN	96	35,040
2025 U.S. internet ad revenue	one attention block	blocks per day	blocks per year
ATTENTIONBID TURNS THE NEXT BLOCK OF DIGITAL ATTENTION INTO A MARKET EVENT.			

01 / MARKET THESIS

Attention Is Valuable. Time Is Scarce. Markets Discover Prices.

Digital advertising has become one of the internet's largest commercial markets. IAB and PwC reported \$294.6 billion in U.S. internet advertising revenue in 2025, up 13.9% year over year; programmatic advertising revenue reached \$162.4 billion. [1]

Those figures do not prove demand for AttentionBid. They establish a more basic fact: businesses already allocate enormous amounts of capital to acquiring digital visibility. AttentionBid changes the market design around that demand.

Conventional digital advertising	AttentionBid
A platform or ad network generally determines allocation through a backend auction, ranking system, negotiated rate, or algorithm. The audience mostly sees the final advertisement, not the market that selected it.	The market itself can be visible: current bids, countdown, clearing price, winner, historical prices and the content that receives the next block can all become part of the product experience.

The platform therefore seeks to create a narrower and more defensible market than the phrase "price of human attention" might imply. AttentionBid is designed to discover the price of its own defined attention inventory at a specific moment.

ATTENTIONBID DOES NOT DECIDE WHAT A BLOCK SHOULD COST. PARTICIPANTS REVEAL WHAT THAT BLOCK IS WORTH TO THEM.

02 / MARKET ARCHITECTURE

The Perpetual Auction

AttentionBid defines one unit of inventory as a 15-minute period of control over its primary attention surface. At the current design parameters, that creates four winning blocks per hour, 96 per day, 2,880 in a 30-day period, and 35,040 in a standard year.

4	96	2,880	35,040
blocks / hour	blocks / day	blocks / 30 days	blocks / year

Temporal scarcity

Once a particular 15-minute period has passed, that exact opportunity cannot be recreated. Additional winning inventory cannot be created without changing the duration or number of simultaneous winning positions.

Continuous renewal

Scarcity does not mean the market ends. The object being sold renews as the next time interval. A losing bidder can compete again immediately, and a spectator can remain for the next outcome.

The resulting sequence is simple: an upcoming block opens for bidding; participants express their valuations; the auction clears; the winner receives control for the defined period; and the next block becomes the new market.

OPEN BLOCK → COMPETITIVE BIDDING → MARKET CLEARS → 15-MINUTE CONTROL → NEXT BLOCK

The perpetual structure matters because it gives the application an internal cadence. Every close creates a winner, a content transition, a new price point, and another opportunity to participate.

03 / PRICE DISCOVERY

A Continuously Updating Market Price

Auction theory is an established framework for allocating scarce resources. The 2020 Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences recognized Paul Milgrom and Robert Wilson for improvements to auction theory and new auction formats, including work applied to radio-frequency allocation. [2]

Milgrom's Nobel materials also describe the importance of price discovery in complex auctions: repeated bidding can help participants learn approximate prices before making final commitments. [3] AttentionBid applies a much simpler version of this idea to a different scarce asset - a defined future interval of digital attention.

Illustrative valuations

Participant A values a block at 50 USDC. Participant B values it at 250. Participant C values it at 700. The platform does not need to decide which valuation is objectively correct.

Observable outcome

Under the auction rules, the winning bid becomes a market observation for that block. The next block may clear at a very different price as participants, traffic, content and context change.

Over time, AttentionBid can create a historical dataset linking winning price to time of day, bidder count, traffic, impressions, click-through behavior, content category, repeat participation and other market variables. If the marketplace develops, this dataset can become an important informational asset in its own right.

04 / MARKETING MARKET-MAKING

When the Auction Becomes Part of the Content

AttentionBid uses the term “marketing market-making” to describe the creation and continuous operation of a marketplace in which participants compete for scarce marketing attention. This is not the conventional financial-market definition of market making.

The central growth hypothesis is reflexive: the mechanism used to sell attention can itself help generate attention. A large bid, a bidding rivalry, a countdown approaching zero, an unexpected winner, or a compelling piece of winning content can become a reason to watch even for someone who is not currently bidding.

Bidder experience

Compete for a scarce block, decide what the opportunity is worth, react to rival bids, experience time pressure, and receive a definitive win/loss outcome.

Spectator experience

Watch price escalation, see who is competing, anticipate the close, discover the winner, and immediately see what content takes control.

Research on retail auctions has found that time pressure and social competition can increase bidder arousal in the conditions studied. Earlier competitive-arousal research identifies rivalry, time pressure and social facilitation as meaningful factors in auction behavior. [4][5]

This does not establish that AttentionBid will be entertaining. It establishes that the product contains several mechanisms associated with competitive arousal. The entertainment thesis should be tested using actual retention, repeat viewing, traffic around auction closes, and spectator-to-bidder conversion.

THE AUCTION MARKETS THE WINNER. THE COMPETITION MARKETS THE AUCTION.

05 / NETWORK EFFECTS

The AttentionBid Flywheel

Marketplace flywheel

More viewers can make control of a block more useful. Greater usefulness can attract more bidders. More bidders can increase competition. More competitive auctions and larger or more surprising outcomes can create additional reasons to watch.

Content flywheel

Each winner changes the homepage. The platform therefore has a built-in source of changing content supplied by market participants rather than a fixed editorial feed.

A third potential loop surrounds the token. Economically aligned holders may have incentives to use the application, share auctions, discuss outcomes, introduce new participants, bid for attention, or promote the market. This does not guarantee those behaviors, but it creates a mechanism through which holders can overlap with users and promoters.

The strongest version of the AttentionBid thesis is therefore not a single network effect but the interaction of three systems: an audience, a competitive market for that audience, and an economically aligned token community.

VIEWERS → ATTENTION VALUE → BIDDERS → COMPETITION → WINNERS / CONTENT → VIEWERS

06 / INFRASTRUCTURE

USDC Settlement on Solana

AttentionBid is designed to operate within the Solana and Circle/USDC ecosystems. USDC is intended as the dollar-denominated bidding asset, while Solana provides blockchain transaction infrastructure.

USDC	1:1	SOLANA	5,000
bidding asset	USD redemption design	native USDC network	lamports base fee / signature

Circle states that USDC is backed by highly liquid cash and cash-equivalent assets and is redeemable 1:1 for U.S. dollars. Circle also supports native USDC on Solana. [6] Solana documentation currently lists a base transaction fee of 5,000 lamports per signature, plus an optional prioritization fee. [7]

The design choice matters for usability and data quality. A winning bid of 500 USDC communicates approximately 500 dollars of nominal bidding value. Historical prices therefore remain easier to interpret than if auctions were denominated solely in a volatile native project token.

AttentionBid intends to pursue relevant grants, ecosystem programs and strategic funding opportunities from Circle and the Solana Foundation. Such funding is prospective unless and until formally awarded.

07 / TOKEN ECONOMICS

Aligning Holders With Platform Activity

Auction economy

USDC is intended to function as the bidding and payment asset. The auction does not require participants to price attention in the AttentionBid token.

Token economy

Under the proposed model, a defined portion of value generated through the AttentionBid application would be distributed pro rata to eligible AttentionBid token holders, subject to final governing terms and applicable law.

Illustrative example: if 100 million eligible tokens participate in a distribution and an account holds 1 million eligible tokens, that account represents 1% of eligible holdings and would receive 1% of the amount designated for that distribution under the final terms.

The token-economic thesis is alignment. A holder with an economic interest in platform activity may also become a user, bidder, promoter, referrer, spectator, or community participant. The goal is to create an ecosystem in which the people most interested in the token have reasons to understand and participate in the underlying product.

PLATFORM ACTIVITY → DEFINED DISTRIBUTION POOL → PRO RATA TOKEN-HOLDER DISTRIBUTION

The token should not be characterized as equity, a utility token, or a non-security unless the final legal structure and governing documents support that characterization.

08 / COMPANY AND ROADMAP

From Product Development to Market Formation

JAN 2026	JUN 2026	2026	LATE 2026
development begins	first public code commits	planned public release	planned token release

AttentionBid is a privately held firm responsible for software development, platform operation, infrastructure, security, moderation, business development, marketing, ecosystem relationships and regulatory compliance.

The initial technical milestone is a functioning perpetual market. The more important commercial milestone comes after launch: proving that the market attracts bidders and spectators, produces repeat participation, generates measurable price history, and creates enough audience value to support competitive bidding.

Future development can include richer market analytics, APIs, expanded content formats, bidder profiles, historical charts, public leaderboards, referral systems, additional wallet integrations, and data products derived from the auction history.

09 / REGULATORY FRAMEWORK

A Developing U.S. Crypto Offering Regime

On August 18, 2026, the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission proposed Regulation Crypto Assets, a tailored regime for certain investment contracts involving crypto assets. The proposal includes one exemption for offerings up to \$5 million during a four-year period and another for offerings up to \$75 million during each 12-month period, subject to conditions and disclosures. [8]

The proposal also includes a conditional safe harbor and principles-based narrative disclosure requirements; the larger exemption would additionally require financial statements and ongoing reporting. The proposal remains subject to public comment and is not a final rule. [8]

AttentionBid's proposed pro rata distribution feature raises securities-law questions that require analysis under the final facts, governing documents and applicable law. The SEC proposal does not automatically classify or exempt the AttentionBid token.

REGULATORY DESIGN IS PART OF TOKEN DESIGN. THE FINAL TOKEN STRUCTURE SHOULD FOLLOW THE APPLICABLE LEGAL PATHWAY.

10 / MEASUREMENT

From White-Paper Thesis to Empirical Evidence

Market & attention metrics	Token & market-quality metrics
Total USDC auction volume; completed auctions; unique and repeat bidders; average and median winning price; viewers; session duration; traffic by block; click-through; spectator-to-bidder conversion.	Eligible token holders; distribution history; holder concentration; holder-to-user conversion; bid depth; competing bidders; price dispersion; repeat winner rate; content diversity.

A strong long-term white paper should become less theoretical with each version. The project's own market history can eventually provide stronger evidence than projections about how users value, watch and participate in the AttentionBid marketplace.

11 / RISKS AND VISION

What Must Be Proven

Adoption risk: sufficient bidders or viewers may not develop. Network-effect risk: the proposed flywheels may not materialize. Entertainment risk: auction research does not establish that AttentionBid itself will be entertaining. Revenue risk: auction activity may not generate meaningful economic value.

Token risk: demand, liquidity and value are uncertain. Regulatory risk: crypto regulation continues to evolve.

Infrastructure risk: the platform depends on Solana, USDC, wallets and other third-party systems. Execution risk: success depends on the private firm's ability to develop, operate and grow the platform.

AttentionBid's long-term objective is to establish a transparent, perpetual marketplace for a clearly defined unit of digital attention. Instead of asking a centralized platform, "What does this advertising space cost?" AttentionBid asks the market a continuously renewed question: "What is the next 15 minutes of AttentionBid attention worth?"

THE AUCTION MARKETS THE WINNER. THE COMPETITION MARKETS THE AUCTION. THE PERPETUAL AUCTION CREATES THE MARKET.

12 / REFERENCES

Selected Sources

[1] IAB/PwC, Internet Advertising Revenue Report: Full Year 2025.

[2] Nobel Prize, Economic Sciences 2020 - Paul Milgrom and Robert Wilson.

[3] Paul R. Milgrom, Nobel biographical materials discussing spectrum auctions and price discovery.

[4] Adam, Krämer & Müller (2015), Auction Fever!, Journal of Retailing 91(3).

[5] Ku, Malhotra & Murnighan (2005), Competitive Arousal Model, Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes 96(2).

[6] Circle, USDC / USDC on Solana / Transparency materials.

[7] Solana Documentation, Fees.

[8] U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission, Proposed Rule: Regulation Crypto Assets, Release No. 33-11434 (Aug. 18, 2026).

Important: This document is an informational discussion draft. It is not legal, tax or investment advice and is not an offer or solicitation to buy or sell any security, token, or other financial instrument.